

Declarer Sheet — Suit

Bridge Habit Map

PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

Discipline

- ☐ Pause at least 10 seconds before playing from dummy
- ☐ Treat it as a play problem handed to you on paper
- ☐ Review the auction — what's bid, what's not
- ☐ Analyse the opening lead — length, honor, shortness?

Pre-play evaluation

- ☐ Count points for us and the defenders
- ☐ Count our winners and losers
- ☐ Use info from opps' bidding and passing
- ☐ Use info from the opening lead
- ☐ Work out likely suit splits and where opps' high cards sit

Design the play

- ☐ Tricks to create = contract – winners
- ☐ Tools: ruff in short hand, create shortage for a ruff, cross-ruff, finesse
- ☐ Look for loser-on-loser elimination, squeeze, or throw-in
- ☐ Confirm entries for the planned play
- ☐ Decide when and how to draw trumps

Playing it out

- ☐ Don't be afraid to draw trumps even on a misfit
- ☐ If cross-ruffing, set up side suits first
- ☐ Play safe / the percentages — allow for 4-1 or 3-0 splits when a finesse is on

PLAN — SUIT

- ☐ If drawing trumps, make sure you have no suit losers in the short-trump hand
- ☐ Find losers in the long hand — discard them on dummy's winners
- ☐ In NT, if they lead your hidden 5-card suit, still play the hand properly
- ☐ If the outcome is fixed, try to fool the opps and sneak a trick

Count

- ☐ Count losers in each suit
- ☐ Pick a master hand (long-trump hand; stronger in 4-4)
- ☐ Cross-check by counting winners

Source of extras

- ☐ Can dummy cover losers? (ruffs, side-suit, finesse, throw-in)
- ☐ Consider dummy reversal, cross-ruff, loser-on-loser, endplay

Trump management

- ☐ Draw trumps now or postpone?
- ☐ If ruffs needed in dummy — set up before drawing
- ☐ Estimate trump leads needed; count opps' trumps as you go

Hazards & control

- ☐ What will defenders attack when they get in?
- ☐ Identify the danger hand — keep them off lead

Execution

- ☐ Plan entries between hands
- ☐ Decide order of attack across suits